



AS & A2 Economics

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Exam Technique Guide

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I Introduction to Exam Technique

- 1.1 What are assessment objectives? The economics exam tests **four types of assessment objectives, knowledge, application of knowledge, analysis and evaluation:**
- o **Level 1** tests your **knowledge** of the syllabus and your ability to **express that knowledge** e.g. the structure of the balance of payments. Or ways of measuring unemployment. Defining terms clearly is often a good way to start an answer
 - o **Level 2** test your ability to **apply your economics knowledge** and understanding to particular problems and issues
 - o **Level 3** tests your ability to **use economic theories and concepts** to **analyse** micro and macroeconomic problems e.g. to use aggregate demand & aggregate supply diagrams to show rising unemployment caused by a negative output gap
 - o **Level 4** tests your ability to **evaluate** problems and policies and make informed and reasoned judgements based on theory and evidence e.g. short term and long term implications. **Evaluation must be based on analysis** for L4 marks to be awarded
- 1.2 What are command words? To help students give the right type of answer, examining boards give **command words**. E.g. Describe means a level 1 answer is required demonstrating knowledge; Discuss or evaluate are level 4 directives

Knowledge & Application of Knowledge	
Calculate	Work out using the information provided
Define	Give the exact meaning
Describe	Give a description of
Give (an account of)	As 'describe'
Give an example	Give a particular example
How (explain how)	In what way or in what ways
Identify	Point out
Illustrate	Give examples/diagram
Outline	Describe without detail
State	Make clear
Summarise	Give main points, without detail

Analyse Economic Problems and Issues	
Analyse	Set out the main points
Apply	Use in a specific way
Compare	Give similarities and differences
Consider	Give your thoughts about
Explain (why)	Give clear reasons or make clear
Justify/account for	Give reasons for

Evaluate Arguments and Evidence, making Informed Judgements

Assess	Show how important something is
Criticise	Give an opinion, support with evidence
Discuss	Give the importance arguments, for and against

	Which Give a clear example/state what	Evaluate Discuss the importance of, making some attempt to weight your opinions To what extent Make a judgement
1.3 How can I pitch my answer to the right level?	Firstly – read the questions very carefully! A common failing in exams is that too many students fail to evaluate when asked to discuss; and too many try to analyse simple low mark level 1 understanding questions. The clue to what is required lies in: □ The command word in the question e.g. Define (level 1) or Explain (level 3) □ The number of marks allocated Analytical and evaluative questions always carry the highest marks AS Economics has more Level 1&2 questions than A2 (40% of the marks are for analysis and evaluation) Level 3&4 questions come after level 1&2 (i.e. the final parts of a structured question) 60% of the marks for the A2 exam are for analysis and evaluation (this is an important difference between AS and A2)	
1.4 What is the economist's toolkit?	Economists draw on a toolkit of concepts and techniques to help to analyse and evaluate problems and potential government policy solutions. E.g. economists use AD-AS analysis when discussing macroeconomic issues and frequently use the tools of welfare economics when discussing issues relating to microeconomics <u>The highest marks in economics exam are reserved for students who think like an economist</u> I.e. who select the appropriate tool from the toolkit to analyse and evaluate.	

2 Evaluation

- 2.1 What is evaluation? Evaluation means **weighing up evidence and arguments**, **making reasoned judgements** to present appropriate and well supported conclusions – based on appropriate analysis. It also means **reasoning your arguments** and **prioritising them**
- 2.2 What criteria can I use to be evaluative? Many answers to questions requiring evaluation can usefully be assessed against these four criteria:
1. **Efficient** i.e. does a particular government policy result in a better use of scarce resources among competing ends? E.g. does it improve allocative, productive and dynamic efficiency and therefore lead to an improvement in welfare? Consider two examples: Will a new tax on aviation fuel be an efficient way of reducing some of the external costs linked to the rapid growth of aviation transport? And, will entry into the single European currency improve the efficiency and competitiveness of markets and industries in the UK economy?
 2. **Effective** i.e. which policy is ***most likely*** to meet a specific objective? For example which policies are likely to be most effective in reducing road congestion? Which policies in the long run have the biggest impact in reducing the natural rate of unemployment? You can often mention the importance of price elasticity of demand and supply when discussing the effectiveness of particular policies. There might be some evidence in the stimulus material in the exam paper that allows you to make a suitable comment on the actual effects of a policy.
 3. **Equitable** i.e. is a policy **fair** or does one group in society gain or lose more than another? Many aspects of government intervention in markets raise issues of **equity** – for example government spending on public and merit goods, changes to direct and indirect taxation etc. There are nearly always winners and losers arising from government intervention. Always have this in the back of your mind when evaluating.
 4. **Sustainable** i.e. does a policy reduce the ability of future generations to engage in economic activity? Inter-generational equity is an important issue in many current policy topics for example decisions on energy policy and economic growth

2.3 How can I adopt a balanced approach when evaluating?	<i>"The higher levels of marks will elude the candidate if there is no attempt to include some explicit evaluation." (AQA Exam Report, June 2004)</i> Examiners will always reward students who adopt a balanced approach and those who try to reason out and explain their arguments i.e. they demonstrate an awareness of different points of view / different schools of thought in Economics - o Monetarist versus Keynesian views on the impact of fiscal and monetary policies as instruments of demand management - o Polluter pays principle versus permits versus command and control (regulation) as means of reducing environmental pollution - o Economists who believe that fixed exchange rates are more effective than allowing a currency to float - o Competing views on the relationship between economic growth and its long-term environmental impact - o Different schools of thought on the benefits of competition versus regulation in a market Discussion of competing theories leads naturally into good evaluation – For example, you may be asked to evaluate how well the market mechanism performs, and the circumstances in which there may be a case for non-market provision of goods or services.
2.4 Commenting on the significance of a policy change or an external shock	Evaluating the significance of something – ask the question - does it actually matter? What are the possible implications of an event such as an external economic shock? Are the effects likely to be merely transitory or will they have important long-term consequences? - o E.g. The significance of a short term change in the exchange rate or in interest rates - o The possible impact of rising global oil prices on developed and developing countries - o Remember that countries will be affected in different ways to the same "shock" e.g. higher oil prices will have different effects for oil importers and oil exporters. There are asymmetries in terms of the effect of a change on different groups, businesses, regions and countries
2.5 The Law of Unintended Consequences and Government Failure	Evaluation is enhanced if you emphasise that government policy changes might have <u>unintended effects</u>. E.g. o Possible government failure from policies designed to correct for market failure E.g. Government intervention to stabilise prices and producer incomes in agricultural markets may cause long term problems of over supply / loss of economic efficiency. Consumers and producers do not always behave in a conventional textbook way. <i>Misguided and unsuccessful intervention then leads to problems of government failure, and provides the case for market forces rather than intervention in determining the allocation of resources. E.g. free provision may lead to over-provision of a merit good and consumers undervaluing the service provided</i>

2.6	Questioning the assumptions upon which a piece of theory is based	Questioning the assumptions on which a particular piece of economic reasoning stands e.g. - o The realism of the assumptions required for efficiency in perfectly competitive markets - o The assumption that export prices always rise and export volumes fall when the exchange rate rises - o Assumptions about how taxpayers will respond if the government cuts taxes in order to give a fiscal stimulus to the economy If the assumptions change, then your analysis may also change – and this can be developed in your answer
2.7	Trying to reach reasoned conclusions	Coming to a reasoned conclusion on the basis of the evidence / supporting examples that you have used Often the conclusion may be that there is insufficient evidence or that not enough time has elapsed to reach a convincing judgement – for example in evaluating the economic effects of the congestion charge or the national minimum wage
2.8	Weight the arguments	Evaluation also involves stating which arguments you believe to be <u>most important</u> and <u>why</u> • Looking at the advantages and disadvantages of policies e.g. - o Electronic road pricing as a means of reducing externalities from congestion compared to other policy options - o Ranking different options for reform of the European Union Common Agricultural Policy
2.9	Use relevant supporting evidence and examples	Use relevant supporting evidence in your arguments. The examiners will always reward reference to recent developments in particular industries and markets, and to developments in both the domestic and international economy Before the exam make sure you are armed with some of the key statistics on the UK and international economy – particularly useful for the macroeconomic essay questions (e.g. on unemployment, inflation, economic growth and the balance of payments)

2.10 Examples of useful
evaluation phrases
to use in answers

Some useful phrases to use to help the examiner!

- o The arguments for and against X are finely balanced....
- o A change in X might cause a change in Y however this depends on Z being held constant.....
- o However, a possible disadvantage of this strategy / policy is that ...
- o The relationship between S and T rests on certain assumptions which may not be the case in reality.....
- o The effects of a change in A depend on the price elasticity of demand and supply.....
- o The argument that X causes Y is actually contradicted by recent evidence which shows that....
- o Although a fall in M should lead to a rise in N, time lags mean that policy changes take time to have their full effect.....
- o Although there are short term effects arising from the introduction of M, the longer-term impact might be more important
- o In conclusion, there are several policy options available to the government. I would argue that policy X is likely to be most effective in achieving the government's objective in the long run. This is because
- o There may be a potential conflict involved with this policy
- o To conclude I would argue that ...
- o The weight of my arguments suggests that policy X is the one that the government should consider first

Good evaluation may be consistent with the view that in economics, *everything depends on everything else!*

3 Macroeconomics Data Response Techniques

3.1 What are the typical data response questions?

The data response questions are ones that students most often find difficult.

A data response question may ask you to:

- **Describe the main changes / fluctuations in a data series** (e.g. annual rates of growth of real GDP; unemployment; measures of inflation; the exchange rate; the balance of payments etc) – including identification of any **relevant trends** in the data.
 - These answers can usually be quite brief. Focus on getting the **main changes** across in your answer – for example, look for **big changes** in a variable – perhaps following a period of relative stability
 - Avoid spending time laboriously trawling through every single monthly or annual change in the data. Look to see if there is any **overall trend**
- 1. **Making relevant comparisons between two or more pieces of data** – backing up each comparison with a relevant statistic. You must provide a point of reference in your answer – e.g. “as chart one shows”, or “the data in table two shows that”
- **Accounting for these changes** (including identifying some of the data presented to you that might help to explain these changes) – e.g. account for a fall in unemployment
- If the question asks you to make use of a diagram then you **must do this!** You cannot ignore a clear instruction to do this. Failure to include a diagram might restrict you to less than half of the marks available
 - a. A decrease in AD is a very different thing from a slowdown in the rate of growth of AD
- 2. **Explain basic economic relationships** between X and Y or X and Y and Z e.g. between interest rates and house prices; between changes in output and changes in employment
- 3. **Identify and evaluate possible effects of government policies** designed to achieve a policy objective (e.g. to achieve a faster sustainable rate of growth or to reduce the scale of a balance of payments deficit)
- 4. **Assess problems in forecasting future movements in economic variables**
- 5. **Assess / evaluate the impact of changes in a variable** (e.g. house prices, unemployment, interest rates, investment, the exchange rate) on the rest of the economy

The early parts of a data response question will involve straightforward data manipulation and explanation.

Calculators at the ready!

You **must make use of a calculator** in a data response paper.

Get your calculator out and work out some percentage changes

Look for the main changes in a data series

Consider the **scale of a change** and **possible correlations** between two data series

The final questions will require use of economic analysis and evaluation and therefore carry many more marks. As in all questions, it is vital to get the timing right! Please don't spend too long on the early questions.

3.2	Explaining basic economic relationships	Clear explanations are required Remember that the direction of causation can change E.g. - o A rise in unemployment might lead to a fall in cost and price inflation - o Buta fall in inflation might (in the long run) lead to a fall in unemployment - o A rise in interest rates might lead to a slow down in house price inflation But..... a sharp slow down in house price inflation or a fall in house prices might encourage a central bank to cut interest rates
3.3	Time lags and problems in forecasting	Many economic relationships are subject to a time lag – this is always worth mentioning – particularly when discussing the likely effects of macro-economic policy changes – e.g. a rise in interest rates should lead to a slowdown in the growth of consumer spending – but in the short run, consumer spending might not react to higher interest rates (i.e. the demand for credit might be inelastic, consumer confidence takes time to respond to interest rate changes etc.) These time lags are difficult to forecast – and this make accurate economic policy-making difficult and subject to error!
3.4	Multiplier effects	An initial stimulus to aggregate demand (e.g. from a rise in government spending or higher capital investment demand) can lead to a much greater final rise in equilibrium national income – the size of the multiplier effect depends on the elasticity of aggregate supply and the size of the marginal propensities to withdraw from the circular flow (MPS, MPM etc). It is often difficult to have precise estimates for the value of the national income multiplier
3.5	Multi-causal factors	No doubt you have found in your revision that many factors can influence an economic variable E.g. - o The causes of unemployment (demand and supply side causes) - o The causes of inflation (cost push and demand pull) - o Reasons behind changes in the exchange rate - o Factors that the Bank of England takes into account when setting interest rates - o Causes of economic growth in both the short run and the long run (AD and LRAS causes) Examiners will always reward students who make an attempt to use relevant economic analysis and make it clear that several factors affect a particular economic variable (inflation, investment spending). Often we make use of the ceteris paribus assumption to isolate in theory the effects of one variable – but the real world does not allow this to happen!

3.6 Economic uncertainty – creates risks!	Most economic decisions are taken under conditions of uncertainty 1. Consumers make consumption decisions without full knowledge of the products they are buying! 2. Firms must make pricing decisions without perfect knowledge of how other firms will react (e.g. in oligopolistic markets) 3. The Government announces spending plans up to three years ahead on the basis of macroeconomic forecasts that may prove to be wide of the mark (the economy might be stronger or weaker than expected – this affects their tax revenue and the amount of money they have available to spend / might have to borrow) Because of economic uncertainty – decisions have to be taken with a degree of risk – the final outcome is rarely exactly equal to the forecast. There is always an error margin – and this raises the possibility of policy mistakes being made. Economic policy making is not an exact science!
3.7 Trade-offs and policy conflicts	Always be aware of possible trade offs between government economic policy objectives. E.g. a desire to see a lower exchange rate to improve the balance of payments might conflict with the desire to maintain control of inflation. The nature of trade-offs can and does change over time – for example the changing Philips Curve – the UK has now had nearly fifteen years of falling unemployment <i>without</i> any significant acceleration in the rate of inflation
3.8 Tips for making effective use of the data in questions	Some of the questions on the data response will ask you to: - o Describe trends in the data (charts/tables etc) - o Outline reasons for the data changing (moving) in a particular way Please try to make effective reference to the data in your answers. <u>Don't simply repeat the information provided</u> – this is a data-response not a data-repeat paper! Things to bear in mind - o Don't mistake levels of for rates of change - e.g. the level of output is different from the rate of change - o Misreading the axes – check them carefully – what exactly is the data showing? - o Has the vertical axis been broken? – if so the scale of a change in a variable (e.g. the exchange rate) might appear to be greater than it actually is - o Is the data expressed in real terms – (i.e. measured at constant prices) When does the data finish? Can you add in more recent data into your answer based on your revision?
3.9 What are the examiners are looking for in data	1. Clear definitions – e.g. making correct use of the terminology of economics 2. Good <u>effective use of the data stimulus</u> – if you ignore the data you cannot pass the exam 3. Explanations of economic relationships / causations

There is scope for diagrams in the data response paper

response papers?	4. Awareness of key objectives of government economic policy 5. Awareness of the different strategies available to governments to meet these objective (i.e. fiscal policy, supply-side policies, direct controls) 6. The limitations of policy – problems in meeting targets and objectives; errors in forecasting and understanding the strength of macroeconomic relationships
3.10 Comment questions	In data questions which state the following "to what extent" or "comment" try the following method: ▪ State the basic theory that the data is trying to prove ▪ State whether the data supports this (yes or no or a partial confirmation if the data shows different things) and then show the relevant figures - e.g. between 90 and 95 GDP went up 20% and so did consumption by 15% proving the theory... ▪ Be careful not to misinterpret the data – in particular the difference between a change in the rate of growth of X (e.g. consumption) and a change in the level of Y (e.g. unemployment) ▪ Say "however" and note where the data may disagree with your theory ▪ Give reasons why the data may disagree e.g. other factors, time lags, forecasting errors

4 Advice on Essay Techniques

4.1 Overview	- o Firstly - read through the question paper – and, if you have a choice of questions, make sure you can do both (all) parts before starting any particular question - o It is a good idea to make a brief plan – but plans should be brief – allocate a couple of minutes to organize your thoughts - o Quality not quantity is what counts – it is not a race to fill the answer booklet - o Timing is crucially important and this is one of the most common failings of students in the exam hall! - o Marks: Look at the mark allocation for each part and assign the right amount of time - o E.g. if you have 45 minutes and part (a) carries 20 marks and part (b) carries 30 marks, then you should spend no more than 18 minutes on part (a) and look to spend 25 minutes on part (b) - o Mark schemes: Well before the exam, try to become familiar with the marking schemes of the exam board that you are taking – each board provides details of their marking schemes and examiners' reports on their web sites. These are well worth looking through, they contain some excellent advice on preparation of particular papers - o AQA: www.aqa.org.uk - o EdExcel: www.edexcel.org.uk - o OCR: www.ocr.org.uk	
4.2 Essay Structure	- o Start with precise definitions - o Then build your answer - explain using text, diagrams and relevant examples and evidence - o Analysis: This nearly always requires some use of diagrams – develop your analysis by changing the elasticity, or shifting some curves around. Don't go right back to square one in your diagrams – most of the examiners are economists (!) and they don't need to be told what demand and supply curves are. Avoid the temptation to fall back on simple supply and demand diagrams when the exam expects a more sophisticated analysis (e.g. in essays on theory of the firm you are expected to use cost and revenue curve analysis) - o Supporting examples and evidence count as knowledge – there are marks for this – and they also help you evaluate when you come to the end of an answer	
4.3 Include a brief concluding paragraph	Each essay should have a brief concluding paragraph. • You might want to question the assumptions of the piece of theory that you have just explained • Argue, "Other factors that affect X need to be taken into account" for a more complete explanation (you are unlikely to have covered every explanation!)	<i>In a conclusion, please don't simply repeat what you have already written (a waste of your</i>

-
- Perhaps make a reference to an event to serve as a reminder of the relationship you have explained *time!*)
-

4.4 Effective discussion – this is a higher order skill	Discussion in an essay involves comparing the costs and benefits or the arguments for and against a particular economic policy or decision. Evaluation also involves putting things in a proper context and not exaggerating the importance of a single event or piece of data Open ended questions – in essays, there is rarely a unique right answer. Examiners will be looking for breadth of argument as well as depth of analysis. It is expected that students will acquire a good knowledge of recent trends and developments in the economy which have taken place during the past ten years but they may also benefit from a general awareness of earlier events when this helps to put the last decade into a meaningful context. <i>(Developments in the United Kingdom should be seen in the context of the globalisation of the world economy and the United Kingdom's membership of the EU.)</i> Good candidates analyse the reasons for recent changes in the UK economy and propose possible solutions to macroeconomic problems. They assess the impact and effectiveness of current government policies to deal with these problems as well as considering <u>alternative policies</u> Consider long and short term effects or policy options, and make a distinction between cyclical and structural causes of a problem <u>Government intervention cannot even begin to cure every macroeconomic ill or microeconomic market failure!</u>	<i>You don't have to come to a definitive conclusion in your essay!</i> <i>Economic awareness and evidence really counts in both AS and A2 exams!</i>
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5 SYNOPTICITY IN ECONOMICS EXAMS

5.1	What is horizontal synopticity?	Horizontal synopticity is where, for example, a macroeconomic concept e.g. relating to aggregate demand, inflation, economic growth etc is introduced into an exam or data response question in a microeconomics paper or vice versa. - For example a question on the behaviour of consumers and businesses within an industry or market can be affected greatly by the impact of the economy's business cycle or by the longer-term effects of globalization - A second example is where the distribution of income and wealth is influenced by the changing pattern of unemployment and movements in real incomes and national house prices Micro and macroeconomics are not separate subjects – there are many strong cross-linkages or inter-relationships between them – your revision should allow you to see how apparently separate topics are actually quite closely related!
5.2	What is vertical synopticity?	Vertical synopticity occurs when material covered in an AS paper (e.g. Markets and Market Failure) is also introduced into an A2 paper question. For example the material covered on price elasticity of demand and supply is often hugely relevant to the pricing behaviour of firms in competitive and concentrated markets. In the AQA exams for example, you are expected in the Unit 5 examination to develop and extend material learnt for the Unit 1 paper at AS particularly in relation to resource allocation and misallocation and the possibility of government failure.
5.3	The importance of synopticity	When you are taking your A2 exams, it is important to realise that all your papers are basically synoptic. The work that you did for AS level acts as a base for a deeper understanding and awareness at A2 level. So don't throw away your AS notes at the end of your first year! They will definitely come in handy when you come to revise for your final papers!

6 ADVICE ON REVISION TECHNIQUES

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|---|--|
| 6.1 Advice for the weeks before the exam | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> o Thorough revision means no cutting of corners and no relying on question spotting as a means of doing well. No single exam can possibly hope to test all of the topics in a syllabus specification, but you must be as thorough as you can in preparation o There is no substitute for writing timed answers to past exam questions and then having them marked your teachers. Knowing what you can realistically achieve in a 45 minute question is hugely important before you step into the exam hall o Watch your diet carefully – eat plenty of good healthy foods that will give you the right amount of energy. But avoid sugary drinks, caffeine and too much grazing. Hydration is important. A small loss of hydration can severely impair your concentration span and capacity for good revision o Do not skimp on much needed sleep! o Revise together in small support groups – help each other, test each other, share some of the workload! o The more you revise the more fluent and knowledgeable you will become. Economics is a circular subject i.e. it is one of those subjects that tends to 'come together' in the final phase of study when you have revised a number of different topics |
| 6.2 Suggestions for active revision ahead of the exam | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> o Make revision notes from your class-notes and supplement your class notes with extra reading o Underline key definitions and get someone to test you on them in the final days before the paper – then test them as well! o Practice drawing key diagrams until you can do them really well and at some speed. They are valuable in the exam and provide useful analysis in answers o Make essay plans from previous papers and discuss them in revision groups with your friends o Read one topical economics article a day and make brief notes on your reading o Learn 5 key definitions every day and two important diagrams every day o Update your knowledge of the UK economy with some salient economic facts to back up your arguments o Try one timed essay or data response question per week and send it to your teachers for marking and feedback |
| 6.3 In the Exam Hall | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> o Above all avoid irrelevance! “it was notable how much writing within scripts goes without gaining credit, simply due to irrelevance” (AQA Examiners’ Report, June 2004) o Take careful note of the mark allocation for each question and allocate your time carefully – be ruthless in your timing and leave sufficient time for the latter parts of questions that always carry higher marks (based on levels of response marking) o Do not waste time copying out the questions, but leave a few lines at the end of each part of your answer in case you have time at the end of the exam to add an extra sentence or two. |
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- o **Only spend 2-3 minutes on an essay plans** - because plans do not count as part of the answer
 - o **Start answers with clear definitions** of the main concepts in the question and then move onto the analysis / explanation (the core of your answer) and evaluation (the important section in the final part)
 - In the AQA essay paper
 - Part (a) of an essay question (worth 20 marks) will ask you to **explain**
 - Part (b) (worth 30 marks) will ask you to **discuss** (i.e. evaluate)
 - o **Develop your analysis using relevant diagrams** where possible. Make sure all diagrams are clearly labelled and explained
 - o **Answer the specific question set** - don't adopt the 'kitchen sink' approach
 - o Remember the importance of command words (see earlier in this revision guide)
 - o Keep referring back to the question – it helps to focus your answer
 - o Look for **key stem words** in the question which must be addressed in your answer
 - o E.g. discuss the effects of a **significant** appreciation of the exchange rate
 - o E.g. evaluate the argument that policies to reduce unemployment must **inevitably cause** higher inflation
 - o **Make fewer points in more detail** rather than attack the examiner with shopping lists
 - o **Bring in relevant evidence and appropriate examples** to supplement your theoretical points
 - o **Be careful with spelling, grammar and presentation** – there are nearly always a few marks awarded for quality of language
 - o **Leave a line between each paragraph** – it helps the examiner to mark your work and also spot your key points and arguments
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6.4 In the exam -
timing your
answers correctly

This is critical! A frequent mistake is to spend too long on lower order questions carrying few marks

Don't exceed the time allowed for each question - if you need to press the "panic button" near the end of the exam write out a series of points in note form (perhaps in a numbered list)

For essay questions carrying 50 marks (e.g. AQA A2 micro and macro essay questions)

Part (a) 16 minutes (20 marks)

Part (b) 25 minutes (30 marks)

Part a) of the essay assesses your understanding of a topic. So use definitions, diagrams, explanations etc

For data response questions carrying 50 marks

Q (a) 3 minutes (4 marks)

Q (b) 5 minutes (6 marks)

Q (c) 8 minutes (10 marks)

Q (d) 24 minutes (30 marks)

Part b) assesses how well you can apply knowledge. If you write fluently and avoid waffle, you can secure a high mark without writing that much, perhaps 3 sides for the essay?

It is crucial that you attempt evaluation. This could be summing up arguments or assessing the relative importance of the issues you are considering, or criticising models

Answer all the parts of the question, preferably in the correct order, sticking rigidly to the time allocation. Do not over-develop your answers to parts (a) and (b) of the question, but remember that a single-sentence answer seldom answers the question properly

6.5 And finally!

Get a nice pen (splash out!), this will avoid the dreaded writers cramp – examiners hate illegible work!

- Please avoid phrases like

- 'massive effects' and 'huge changes', 'inevitably' and 'will definitely'

Please do not use signs and arrows as a substitute for words

Please do not use bullet point lists as a substitute for properly developed explanation and development of your arguments

Please avoid overt political comments that have no place in objective economic analysis and discussion

Helpful links on the Tutor2u web site:

- Discussion Forum: www.tutor2u.net/forum/default.asp
- Links to all of our updated resources: www.tutor2u.net/default2.asp

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- Practice multiple choice tests (mainly for AS) <http://www.tutor2u.net/quiz/default.asp>
 - Revision Notes: http://www.tutor2u.net/revision_notes.asp
 - Revision presentations: <http://www.tutor2u.net/presentations.asp>
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